

The solution to  $-4 < 2(x - 1) < 8$  is expressed in the form  $a < x < b$ . Find the value of  $a + b$ .

Step 45 ...  $a + b = -2 + 4 = 2$  ... Answer :  $\boxed{2}$  ... ❌

Step 115 ...  $a + b = -M + M = 2$  ... Answer :  $\boxed{2}$  ...

Step 135 ...  $a + b = -1 + 5 = M$  ... Answer :  $\boxed{2}$  ...

Step 138 ...  $a + b = -1 + 5 = 4$  ... Answer :  $\boxed{M}$  ...

Step 139 ...  $a + b = -1 + 5 = 4$  ... Answer :  $\boxed{4}$  ... ✅